



WITNESSING FOR THE LESS-CONFIDENT CHRISTIAN

Faithful Conversations Without Fear

Card 1 of 3



“The servant of the Lord must not strive; but be gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient.” — 2 Timothy 2:24

THE PRESSURE WE IMAGINE

- I must answer every objection.
- Tension means I have failed.
- I must convince them immediately.

THE FAITHFUL POSTURE

Witnessing is usually more like planting and watering than delivering a courtroom speech. Listen carefully. Ask thoughtful questions. Seek understanding. Find common ground. Speak honestly. Patiently place truth on the table.

WHAT YOU ARE — AND ARE NOT — CALLED TO DO

NOT CALLED TO

- Know everything
- Dominate the exchange
- Force immediate agreement
- Change another person’s heart

CALLED TO

- Be faithful
- Speak truthfully
- Act patiently
- Love sincerely

KINGDOM PRINCIPLE

The goal is not domination. The goal is faithful engagement.

ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY

Faithful witnessing is usually less about pressure and more about presence.

A GENTLE METHOD FOR GOSPEL CONVERSATIONS



Card 2 of 3

1 EXPLORE BEFORE YOU CORRECT

Questions lower defenses, communicate respect, and reveal what a person actually believes.

- “Help me understand how you see that.”
- “What led you to that conclusion?”
- “What do you think Christianity is mainly about?”

2 BUILD SHARED GROUND

Begin with sincere agreements: objective morality, the brokenness of the world, guilt, forgiveness, truth, suffering, meaning, family, and admiration for Jesus.

You are not avoiding truth. You are building a bridge sturdy enough to carry harder truths later.

3 ASK BEFORE YOU ARGUE

- “What do you mean by that?”
- “How are you defining that word?”
- “What convinces you of that?”

Clarification lowers the emotional temperature and prevents strawman arguments.

4 PRACTICE PATIENCE

Family conversations often unfold over years. Leave thoughtful questions in the mind. Revisit subjects later. Faithfulness is not measured by speed.

5 PUT TRUTH ON THE TABLE

Not every conversation must end in resolution. Speak faithfully, then leave room for conscience, Scripture, time, and the Holy Spirit.

REMEMBER

Gentleness is not weakness. It is strength under control.

AFTER THE FUNERAL

A Lesson in Timing, Truth, and Tenderness



Card 3 of 3

THE MOMENT

A grieving Roman Catholic relative asks, “Please pray for his soul.” The Reformed Christian knows the doctrinal differences: justification is complete in Christ; there is no purgatory; after death comes judgment (Hebrews 9:27). But he also recognizes that the moment is fragile.

THE WISER FIRST RESPONSE

“It sounds like you really loved him.”

He begins not with confrontation, but with grief, fear, hope, guilt, assurance, Christ, and the longing to know that someone is finally safe with God.

QUESTIONS FOR A LATER CONVERSATION

- Can we ever truly know we are forgiven?
- Did Christ’s sacrifice fully pay for sin?
- What gives a person assurance before God?
- What did Jesus mean when He said, “It is finished”?

LESSONS TO CARRY

1. Not every error must be corrected immediately.
2. Seek the deeper concern beneath the doctrine.
3. Build shared agreements first.
4. Remember that family conversations usually continue.

GENTLE PRINCIPLE

You do not need to force every disagreement into the open immediately.

BOTTOM LINE

Truth matters deeply. But how and when truth is spoken matters too.